

Dustin Fichmann

University of California, Berkeley, CA, USA

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Research Interests: Behavioral Economics & Political Economy

Education

University of California, Berkeley

PhD Student in Economics

Berkeley, CA, USA

Aug. 2026 – Present

Columbia University

M.A. in Economics

New York, NY, USA

Sept. 2021 – Dec. 2022

Bates College

B.A. in Mathematics and Economics (double major)

Lewiston, ME, USA

Aug. 2017 – May 2021

University of Oxford

Visiting Student, Economics

Oxford, UK

Oct. 2019 – Jun. 2020

Research Positions

Harvard University, Department of Economics

Pre-Doctoral Fellow in Behavioral-Economic Theory (with Prof. Matthew Rabin)

Cambridge, MA

Jul. 2025 – Jul. 2026

Harvard Business School

Pre-Doctoral Fellow in Behavioral Economics (with Prof. Thomas Graeber)

Boston, MA

Jun. 2024 – Jul. 2025

World Data Lab

Data Scientist (with Dr Homi Kharas)

Vienna, Austria

Aug. 2023 – May 2024

Columbia University – Program for Economic Research

Research Assistant (with Prof. Brendan O’Flaherty)

New York, NY

May 2022 – Apr. 2023

Work in Progress

Algorithm Neglect

Do people become overconfident when they neglect how social media algorithms select the information they see?

Conformity and Online Communities

What are the consequences of conformity pressures when people can easily find like-minded communities online?

Independent Research Projects

Perceptions of Crime and the Gender Commuting Gap

2022

Combined ACS and FBI crime data to study the relationship between crime risk and gender gaps in commuting.

What Role Does Income Play in Urban Housing Choices?

2021

Used ACS PUMS to test the correlation between income and commute time, holding commute mode fixed.

Honors and Fellowships

2027–2028 **O'Donnell Center Fellowship**

UC Berkeley

2021 **Summa Cum Laude, Phi Beta Kappa, Sigma Xi, Dean's List**

Bates College

2017–2021 **Shelby Davis Scholarship**

Bates College / UWC

2020 **Book Prizes for Excellence in Behavioral and Labor Economics**

University of Oxford

2018 **Dana Scholar Award**

Bates College

Teaching

2026 **Harvard – ECON 2030 Psychology and Economics (Rabin & Laibson)**, 2nd-year PhD TA

Boston, MA

2024 **Harvard Business School – MBA Negotiations (Graeber)**, Grader

Boston, MA

2018–2019 **Bates College – Mathematics and Statistics Workshop**, Math Tutor

Lewiston, ME

2018 **Lewiston High School**, Math Tutor

Lewiston, ME

Presentations

2022 **Perceptions of Crime and the Gender Commuting Gap**, Columbia University

New York, NY

2021 **Collision Algorithms and Pollard's ρ Method**, Mount David Summit – Bates College

Lewiston, ME

Languages & Skills

Languages: English & German (native); Spanish (intermediate); French, Italian & Mandarin (elementary).

Programming: Stata; R; Python; Matlab; JavaScript; HTML; $\text{\LaTeX}$; Qualtrics.

Interests: Coffee, Freediving, Skiing & Mountain Biking.